

Cravings FAQ

Updated after each live group call · Replay 1 · Nutrition and Cravings Deep Dive

Living document: new questions from each live call are added under "Latest from the call." All stories are anonymized; no outcome numbers.

The foundations

Why do I crave sugar at the same time every day? Because the craving was scheduled hours earlier by a blood-sugar rebound (Lennerz et al., *AJCN*) or by a short night (Greer et al., *Nature Communications*). Fix the meal before the craving hour: protein and fat at lunch for a 3 p.m. craving; dinner plus the walk for a 9 p.m. one.

Is it weakness? No. Highly palatable food engages the brain's wanting circuit (Volkow et al.); cue reactivity predicts eating better than hunger does (Boswell & Kober, *Obesity Reviews*). Cravings are signals with three roots: emotional, environmental, physiological. Track for three days (Module 1) and the pattern appears.

How long does a craving last? Most urges rise, crest and pass within about twenty minutes (urge surfing, Bowen & Marlatt). The pause, a ten-minute timer and something warm in your hands covers most of it.

Food and swaps

What's the single best swap? Never sweet alone: berries + walnuts, dark chocolate + almonds, apple + nut butter, the fix smoothie. Protein and fat stop the rebound.

Are artificial sweeteners a good swap? Mostly no: they keep the sweet expectation alive and bring none of the protein, fat and fiber that quiets the loop. Berry-basil sparkling water is the swap. An occasional diet soda is not a crisis.

Is coffee okay? Moderate (1–2 cups) hasn't been linked to reduced fertility in the ASRM review; ACOG advises under 200 mg/day in pregnancy. Morning only; a glass of water after each cup. Energy drinks: no.

Fruit has sugar. Should I avoid it? No. Whole fruit brings fiber and polyphenols and was associated with faster conception in a large cohort (Grieger et al., *Human Reproduction*). Eat it with protein or fat when it's a snack.

Where do I start with gut health? One tablespoon of sauerkraut or a quarter cup of kefir daily for two weeks, then build; thirty different plants a week; fiber up slowly with water (Wastyk et al., *Cell*). Food before probiotic supplements; ask your doctor or dietitian about supplements.

Situations

Travel? Pack the swaps (walnuts, dark chocolate, tea bags, a short-list protein bar), protein at breakfast, walk on arrival, lower the bar to "no sweet alone and one good night's sleep."

The week before my period? Cravings and appetite rise with hormones. Protein and fat at every meal, expect a bigger wave, use the pause and the fix smoothie more, and don't audit yourself that week.

Evenings are my downfall. The evening craving is fixed at noon (protein and fat), after dinner (the walk) and at nine (phone to the kitchen). If it's about the hard day rather than blood sugar, ask "what do I actually need?" (Module 4). Usually rest.

My partner won't change. Once, gently: half of fertility rests with him, sperm rebuilt every three months, the walnut study is two handfuls a day with nothing removed (Robbins et al.). Then cook the plate and put it on the table without a lecture. Your changes make his more likely (Jackson et al., *JAMA Internal Medicine*).

I have PCOS. Lifestyle first (Endocrine Society); low-GI eating improved insulin sensitivity and cycle regularity (Marsh et al., *AJCN*); small slow-carb portion, protein and fat every meal, the after-meal walk; ask your doctor about myo-inositol. The plan runs alongside your specialist.

I feel better without gluten. Do I still need the celiac test? Yes. The blood test only works while you're eating gluten; ask your doctor about a supervised gluten challenge before testing. Knowing changes your care for life.

I slipped badly. Have I undone everything? No. A missed day doesn't change the long-term outcome (Lally); the body clears. Say the slip script, do the reset, text your person (THE FIX Session 3).

Latest from the call

(Added after each live session.)

- Q: _____ A: _____
- Q: _____ A: _____

Three quick wins

1. Fix the meal before your craving hour.
2. One fermented food on the counter, one spoon a day.
3. The pause: "there it is," ten-minute timer, something warm in your hands. Partners: two handfuls of walnuts a day.

Educational content only, not medical advice. Always consult your doctor or a qualified health professional before changing supplements, diet, exercise or detox practices, especially while trying to conceive.